

Essential Expressions for travel

Booking & Reservations

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
"I would like to make a reservation for [date]."	"I would like to make a reservation for June 10, please."
"Do you have any rooms available for [date]?"	"Do you have any rooms available for this Friday?"
"Can I book a table for [number] people?"	"Can I book a table for four people at 7 PM?"
"How much is a one-night stay?"	"How much is a one-night stay in a standard room?"
"Is breakfast included in the price?"	"Is breakfast included in the room price?"
"Can I change my reservation?"	"Can I change my reservation to a later date?"
"I need to cancel my reservation."	"I need to cancel my reservation for July 5th."
"Can you confirm my booking?"	"Can you confirm my booking for next weekend?"
"Are there any discounts available?"	"Are there any discounts available for long stays?"
"What is your cancellation policy?"	"What is your cancellation policy if I need to change?"

Money & Payments

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
"Where can I exchange money?"	"Where can I exchange money? I only have RMB."
"Where is the nearest ATM?"	"Where is the nearest ATM? I need to withdraw cash."
"Do you accept Alipay or WeChat Pay?"	"Do you accept Alipay? I don't have cash with me."
"Is there a service charge?"	"Is there a service charge if I pay by card?"
"Is the tip included?"	"Is the tip included in the bill, or should I leave extra?"
"What's the exchange rate today?"	"~ I want to change 500 RMB."

At the Airport & During Travel

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“Where is the check-in counter?”	“Where is the check-in counter for my flight to XX?”
“Can I see your passport and ticket?”	“Can I see your passport and ticket, please?”
“I have a connecting flight to XX.”	“I have a connecting flight to... Where should I go?”
“What time does my flight depart?”	“What time does my flight to New York depart?”
“Where is the security check?”	“Where is the security check? I’m in a hurry.”
“Is my flight on time or delayed?”	“Is my flight to Tokyo on time or delayed?”
“Where is the baggage claim area?”	“~ for international flights?”
“Do I need to fill out an immigration form?”	“~ for this flight?”
“Where can I find a taxi or shuttle?”	“Where can I find a taxi or shuttle to the city center?”
“Excuse me, where is gate [number]?”	“Excuse me, where is gate 32 for my flight?”

Customs & Immigration

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“I have nothing to declare.”	“~ I only brought clothes and gifts.”
“How much can I bring in duty-free?”	“~ I bought two bottles of wine.”
“I’m here on vacation.” “I	’m here on vacation with my family.”
“I’m staying for five days.”	“I’m staying for five days, until next Tuesday.”
“I’m staying at the Grand Hotel.”	“I’m staying at the Grand Hotel near the city center.”
“Do I need to fill out a customs form?”	“~ before I leave the airport?”

Flight Issues

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“My flight was canceled. What should I do?”	“~ Can you help me rebook?”
“Can I rebook my flight for tomorrow?”	“Can I rebook my flight for tomorrow morning?”
“I missed my connecting flight.”	“~ in Singapore. Is there another flight today?”
“Can I get a refund for my ticket?”	“~ I can’t travel this week.”
“The gate changed. Where is the new gate?”	“The gate changed to gate 15. Where is gate 15?”
“Will I still make my connecting flight?”	“~ My first flight is late.”

Luggage & Lost & Found

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“My luggage didn’t arrive. Where can I report it?”	“My suitcase didn’t arrive. Where can I report it?”
“When will my luggage arrive?”	“When will my luggage arrive? I need my medicine.”
“I left my bag on the train/bus.”	“~ Where is the lost and found office?”
“Where is the lost and found office?”	“~ I lost my umbrella.”
“Can I track my luggage?”	“Can I track my luggage with this receipt?”
“This bag is not mine.”	“This bag is not mine. Mine has a red tag.”

Using Transportation

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“How much is a ticket to [destination]?”	“How much is a ticket to Paris?”
“What time does the [bus/train/subway] leave?”	“What time does the next train leave for Rome?”
“Is this the right bus/train to [destination]?”	“Is this the right bus to Central Station?”
“Do I need to buy a return ticket?”	“Do I need to buy a return ticket for this tour?”
“Where can I buy a ticket?”	“Where can I buy a ticket for the subway?”
“How long does it take to get to [place]?”	“How long does it take to get to the airport ?”
“Can I get a taxi to [destination]?”	“Can I get a taxi to the Grand Hotel?”
“Is this seat taken?”	“Excuse me, is this seat taken?”
“Can I have a one-way ticket to [XX], please?”	“Can I have a one-way ticket to Madrid, please?”
“Where do I get off for [place]?”	“Where do I get off for the National Museum?”

Ride-hailing

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“I booked a ride. Where should I wait?”	“I booked a ride to the airport. Where should I wait?”
“What’s the plate number of my ride?”	“~ I’m at the hotel entrance.”
“Please pick me up at the hotel entrance.”	“~ in ten minutes.”
“Can you take me to this address?”	“~ It’s the train station.”
“How long will the driver take to arrive?”	“How long will the driver take to arrive? I’m in a hurry.”
“The app shows a different car.”	“The app shows a different car. Is this my ride?”

Asking for Directions

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“Excuse me, can you help me?”	“Excuse me, can you help me? I’m lost.”
“How do I get to [place]?”	“How do I get to the airport from here?”
“Where is the nearest [bank/hotel/restaurant]?”	“Where is the nearest hotel? I need a place to stay.”
“Is it far from here?”	“Is it far from here to the museum?”
“Can you show me on the map?”	“Can you show me on the map where xxx is?”
“Which way should I go?”	“Which way should I go to reach the city center?”
“Is it on the left or right?”	“Is the park on the left or right side of the street?”
“How long does it take to walk there?”	“How long does it take to walk to the restaurant?”
“Can I take a bus or train to get there?”	“Can I take a bus to get to the museum?”
“Thank you for your help!”	“Thank you for your help! I appreciate it.”

Hotel Check-in

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“I have a reservation under the name [XX].”	“I have a reservation under the name John Smith.”
“Do you have any rooms available?”	“Do you have any rooms available for tonight?”
“What time is check-in/check-out?”	“What time is check-in? I will be arriving at noon.”
“Can I see the room before I book?”	“Can I see the room before I book?”
“Does the room come with free Wi-Fi?”	“Does the room come with free Wi-Fi? I need to work.”
“Is breakfast included?”	“Is breakfast included in the room price?”
“Can I get a wake-up call at [time]?”	“Can I get a wake-up call at 7 AM?”
“Can I have an extra towel/pillow?”	“Can I have an extra pillow, please?”
“Where is the nearest restaurant?”	“Where is the nearest restaurant? I’m getting hungry!”
“Can I store my luggage here?”	“Can I store my luggage here after check-out?”

Hotel Problems

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“The air conditioner doesn’t work.”	“~ Can you send someone to fix it?”
“There’s no hot water in my room.”	“~ Can I change rooms?”
“Can I change rooms? Room 302 is too noisy.”	“~ at night.”
“My room key doesn’t work.”	“~ Can you make a new one?”
“The Wi-Fi in my room is very slow.”	“~ Can I use the lobby Wi-Fi?”
“Can I have a different room?”	“~ The window doesn’t close.”

Ordering Food & Drinks

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“Can I see the menu, please?”	“Can I see the menu, please? I’m ready to order.”
“What do you recommend?”	“What do you recommend? I’m not sure what to choose.”
“I’d like to order [dish/drink], please.”	“I’d like to order the chicken curry, please.”
“Does this dish contain [ingredient]?”	“Does this dish contain peanuts? I have an allergy.”
“Can I have it without [ingredient]?”	“Can I have it without onions, please?”
“Is this spicy?”	“Is this curry spicy? I can’t handle too much spice.”
“Can I get a glass of water, please?”	“Can I get a glass of water, please? It’s very hot outside.”
“Can I have the bill/check, please?”	“Can I have the bill, please? I’m done eating.”
“Do you accept credit cards?”	“Do you accept credit cards or only cash?”
“That was delicious! Thank you!”	“That was delicious! Thank you for the wonderful meal.”

Shopping

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“How much does this cost?”	“How much does this cost? I want to know the price.”
“Do you have this in a different size/color?”	“Do you have this in a larger size? This one is too small.”
“Can I try this on?”	“Can I try this on before I buy it?”
“Do you accept credit cards?”	“Do you accept credit cards, or is it cash only?”
“Can I get a discount?”	“Can I get a discount if I buy two?”
“That’s too expensive.”	“That’s too expensive. Can you lower the price a little?”
“What’s your best price?”	“What’s your best price for this souvenir?”
“Can I get a tax refund on this?”	“Can I get a tax refund on this purchase at the airport?”
“I’ll take it!”	“I’ll take it! It’s perfect.”
“Can I get a receipt, please?”	“Can I get a receipt, please? I need it for tax refund.”

Returns & Exchanges

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“Can I return this?”	“I’d like to return this shirt. It’s too small.”
“Can I exchange this for a bigger size?”	“Can I exchange these shoes for a bigger size?”
“Here is my receipt.”	“Here is my receipt. I bought this yesterday.”
“Can I get a refund?”	“Can I get a refund for this jacket? It’s broken.”
“This charger doesn’t work.”	“This charger doesn’t work. Can I exchange it?”
“What’s your return policy?”	“~ Can I return it within a week?”

Visiting Tourist Places

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“How much is the entrance fee?”	“How much is the entrance fee for the museum?”
“What time does the tour start?”	“What time does the castle tour start?”
“Is there a guided tour available?”	“Is there a guided tour available for the palace?”
“Can I take pictures here?”	“Can I take pictures inside the gallery?”
“Where is the nearest restroom?”	“Where is the nearest restroom in the park?”
“Are there any special exhibits today?”	“Are there any special exhibits at the museum today?”
“How long does the tour last?”	“How long does the walking tour last?”
“What is the best time to visit [place]?”	“What is the best time to visit the XX?”
“Can you recommend XX?”	“Can you recommend any other places nearby?”
“Where is the information desk?”	“Where is the information desk in this museum?”

Discussing Weather

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“What's the weather like today?”	“~ Should I bring an umbrella?”
“Is it going to rain today?”	“~ I need to plan my trip.”
“It looks like it's going to be sunny.”	“~ Perfect for a picnic!”
“It's really hot today!”	“~ I need a cold drink.”
“How cold is it going to get tonight?”	“~ Should I wear a jacket?”
“Is there a chance of snow?”	“~ this weekend?”
“It's pretty windy today.”	“~ Hold onto your hat!”

Internet & Connectivity

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“What's the Wi-Fi password?”	“What's the Wi-Fi password? I need to call my family.”
“Can I get an eSIM for tourists?”	“~ I need internet for maps.”
“My phone has no signal.”	“My phone has no signal. Can I use your Wi-Fi?”
“Is there free Wi-Fi in this area?”	“~ I don't want to use my data.”
“How much data does this plan include?”	“~ I need it for one week.”
“Can you help me set up the Wi-Fi?”	“~ It's not working on my phone.”

Talking to Locals on a Trip

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“Hello, how are you?”	“Hello, how are you today?”
“Can you help me, please?”	“Can you help me, please? I can’t find my hotel.”
“I’m lost. Can you show me the way?”	“I’m lost. Can you show me the way to the park?”
“What is the best way to get to [XX]?”	“What is the best way to get to the airport?”
“Do you speak English?”	“Excuse me, do you speak English?”
“How far is [place] from here?”	“How far is the shopping mall from here?”
“What time does [place/attraction] close?”	“What time does the museum close?”
“Can I get a local SIM card here?”	“Can I get a local SIM card here for internet?”
“What’s your favorite place to visit around here?”	“What’s your favorite place to visit in this area?”
“Is it safe to walk around here at night?”	“Is it safe to walk around here at night alone?”

Handling Emergencies

EXPRESSION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
“I need help!”	“I need help! Can someone assist me?”
“I’ve lost my passport/wallet.”	“I’ve lost my passport. What should I do?”
“Where is the nearest hospital?”	“Where is the nearest hospital? I need medical help.”
“I need a doctor.”	“I need a doctor. I’m not feeling well.”
“Can you call the police?”	“Can you call the police? My bag was stolen.”
“I’ve been robbed.”	“I’ve been robbed. I need to report it.”
“I need to report an accident.”	“I need to report an accident on Main Street.”
“Where is the nearest embassy?”	“Where is the nearest embassy? I need assistance.”
“Is there a pharmacy nearby?”	“Is there a pharmacy nearby? I need some medicine.”